Let Both *Grow Together*

Allow both to grow together until the harvest.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 13:24-43 in the LSB | 28:34 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Matthew 13:24-43 – The Hidden Truth Behind the Wheat and Weeds. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 13:24-43. Jesus tells three new parables: an enemy sows tares among the wheat, and the master tells his slaves to wait for the harvest (13:24-30); a mustard seed becomes a tree where birds nest (13:31-32); leaven is hidden in three sata of flour until all is leavened (13:33). In the house He explains the tares (13:36-43).
- Pay attention to what is unexpected. Quoting Craig Blomberg, 'Jesus frequently stands conventional expectation on its head.' The slaves want to pull the tares at once; the master says no. Mustard does not grow into a tree, yet Jesus says it becomes one. And this harvest is slower and gentler than the axe John the Baptist preached (3:10-12), which may be why John asked, 'Are You the One who is to come?' (11:3).
- Keep the forest in view: by chapter 12 the Pharisees were plotting to destroy Jesus (12:14) and saying His power came from Beelzebul (12:24). The disciples must have wondered why the Messiah faced such opposition, and whether they should do something about it.
- Old Testament hints (remez): the tree where birds nest echoes God's parable of the cedar sprig in Ezekiel 17:22-24; the three measures of flour echo Sarah's bread for the three visitors at Mamre (Genesis 18:6); and 'gnashing of teeth' echoes the Psalms, where the wicked gnash at the righteous (Psalm 35:16; 37:12).

> *"Pay attention to what's unexpected.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"The servants of Jesus must treat the lost in the world the way they treat their own.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- The parables of chapter 13 form a chiasm (13:3-52), and the video sees the explanation of the tares at its center. The lesson for the disciples: the servants of Jesus must treat the lost in the world the way they treat their own, trusting that God, not man, will remove all sin and sinners on the last day. The delay of the harvest is God's gift of time, and a weed may become wheat, as Saul the persecutor became Paul.



The enemy who sows

James Tissot, The Enemy Who Sows, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Look for the twist

The teacher's tip for any parable: ask what a first-century Jewish listener would have found unexpected. The slaves' plan to pull the tares, a mustard seed that becomes a tree, and a harvest that waits: the surprise is where the lesson hides.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 13:24-43 and turns to Matthew 3, 11 and 12, Ezekiel 17, Genesis 18 and Psalms 35 and 37. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 13:24-43
Read in full: the tares, the mustard seed, the leaven, and the tares explained.

Matthew 3:10-12
John's axe and winnowing fork.

Matthew 11:2-3
'Are You the One who is to come?'

Matthew 12:14
The Pharisees plot to destroy Him.

Matthew 12:24
'By Beelzebul the ruler of the demons.'

Ezekiel 17:22-24
God plants a cedar sprig; birds of every kind dwell under it.

Genesis 18:1-8
Three seahs of fine flour for the three visitors.

Psalms 35:15-16
They gnashed at me with their teeth.

Psalms 37:12
The wicked gnashes at the righteous.

Acts 9:1-6
Saul the persecutor meets Jesus.

Matthew 13:44-58
Coming next: the last parables of the chapter.

Key verses in the LSB

> “Allow both to grow together until the harvest; and in the time of the harvest I will say to the reapers, “First gather up the tares and bind them in bundles to burn them up; but gather the wheat into my barn.””
>
> Matthew 13:30 (LSB)

> “Then the righteous will shine forth as the sun in the kingdom of their Father. He who has ears, let him hear.”
>
> Matthew 13:43 (LSB)

> “On the high mountain of Israel I will plant it, that it may lift up boughs and yield fruit and become a majestic cedar. And birds of every kind will dwell under it; they will dwell in the shade of its

branches.”

Ezekiel 17:23 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Three parables and their twists

The tares, the mustard seed, the leaven, and a slower harvest than John expected.

MATTHEW 13:24-30

An enemy has done this

MATTHEW 13:27-30 (LSB)

THE TARES

“The slaves of the landowner came and said to him, ‘Sir, did you not sow good seed in your field? How then does it have tares?’ And he said to them, ‘An enemy has done this!’ The slaves *said to him, ‘Do you want us, then, to go and gather them up?’ But he *said, ‘No; for while you are gathering up the tares, you may uproot the wheat with them. Allow both to grow together until the harvest; and in the time of the harvest I will say to the reapers, “First gather up the tares and bind them in bundles to burn them up; but gather the wheat into my barn.”””

FROM THE VIDEO The story tracks along the slaves' expectations: fix the problem right away, find every weed, and pull it up so the wheat can flourish. The twist is the master's emphatic 'No.' They must wait until the harvest (13:30).

FROM THE VIDEO Quoting Craig Blomberg: 'Jesus frequently stands conventional expectation on its head.' Our job is to respect the first-century mindset so we can spot what would have surprised a Jewish listener.

◆ Factbook: Parable

MATTHEW 13:31-32

A seed that becomes a tree

MATTHEW 13:31-32 (LSB)

MUSTARD

“He presented another parable to them, saying, “The kingdom of heaven is like a mustard seed, which a man took and sowed in his field; and this is the smallest of all seeds, but when it is fully grown, it is the largest of the garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and nest in its branches.””

FROM THE VIDEO Mustard seeds do not grow into huge trees; they grow into shrubs. But Jesus says 'a tree.' That surprise is a clue to look for a remez, a hint back to the Old Testament.

FROM THE VIDEO The kingdom starts small and grows until it is a tree where the birds of the air come and nest.

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven

MATTHEW 13:33-35

Hidden in three sata of flour

MATTHEW 13:33 (LSB)

LEAVEN

“He spoke another parable to them, “The kingdom of heaven is like leaven, which a woman took and hid in three sata of flour until it was all leavened.””

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus said nothing to the crowds without a parable, fulfilling 'I will open My mouth in parables' (13:34-35). Matthew 13:34-35

BACKGROUND Matthew quotes Psalm 78:2, a psalm of Asaph, as spoken 'through the prophet': 'I will open my mouth in a parable; / I will pour forth dark sayings of old' (Psalm 78:2). Psalms 78:2

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms

MATTHEW 3 AND 11

A slower harvest than John expected

JOHN THE BAPTIST · MATTHEW 3:10

“And the axe is already laid at the root of the trees; therefore every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire.”

JOHN'S QUESTION · MATTHEW 11:3

“and said to Him, “Are You the One who is to come, or shall we look for someone else?””

FROM THE VIDEO John preached judgment already at hand. Jesus says the judgment at the end of the age comes once the leaven has worked through all the flour, the mustard seed has become a tree, and the wheat has matured. The video suggests this gap led to John's question in 11:3.

FROM THE VIDEO So keep the forest in view: in chapter 12 the Pharisees plotted to destroy Jesus and called His power Beelzebul's. The disciples must have asked, 'Why is all this opposition happening? Should we do something about it?' Matthew 12:14 Matthew 12:24

◆ Factbook: John the Baptist ◆ Factbook: Pharisees



Tares among the wheat

Abraham Bloemaert, Parable of the Wheat and the Tares, 1624. Walters Art Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Pay attention to what's unexpected.

From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Old Testament hints

Ezekiel's cedar, Sarah's bread, and gnashing of teeth in the Psalms.

EZEKIEL 17:22-24

The cedar sprig on the mountain

EZEKIEL 17:22-23 (LSB)

REMEZ

“Thus says Lord Yahweh, “I will also take a sprig from the lofty top of the cedar and set it out; I will pluck from the topmost of its young twigs a tender one, and I will plant it on an exalted and lofty mountain. On the high mountain of Israel I will plant it, that it may lift up boughs and yield fruit and become a majestic cedar. And birds of every kind will dwell under it; they will dwell in the shade of its branches.”

FROM THE VIDEO This kind of tree, with birds nesting in its branches, appears in God's own parable in Ezekiel 17. That parable is about what God will do to make His people a blessing for the nations.

FROM THE VIDEO The tree pictures God's people; the birds picture the nations, the Gentiles. Like the mustard seed, it starts small and grows.

BACKGROUND Daniel 4 uses the same picture for Nebuchadnezzar's kingdom: 'the birds of the sky inhabited its branches' (Daniel 4:12). Daniel 4:12

◆ Factbook: Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Gentiles

GENESIS 18:1-8

Three seahs of fine flour

GENESIS 18:6 (LSB)

HOSPITALITY

“So Abraham hurried into the tent to Sarah and said, “Hurry, prepare three seahs of fine flour, knead it, and make bread cakes.””

FROM THE VIDEO 'Three measures' is a very specific phrase. It goes back to Abraham and Sarah preparing bread for the three visitors at the oaks of Mamre, who turn out to be the Lord (Genesis 18:1-2). Genesis 18:1-2

FROM THE VIDEO The video leaves this link for you to meditate on: Jesus ties the kingdom to Sarah's bread, an act of hospitality to bless the Lord.

◆ Factbook: Abraham ◆ Factbook: Sarah

PSALMS 35 AND 37

Weeping and gnashing of teeth

DAVID · PSALMS 35:16

DAVID · PSALMS 37:12

“Amongst the godless jesters at a feast, / They gnashed at me with their teeth.”

“The wicked schemes against the righteous / And gnashes at him with his teeth.”

FROM THE VIDEO The phrase in 13:42 comes out of the Psalms. In the Old Testament, gnashing teeth is what the unrighteous do to the righteous: a sign of disrespect and mockery, not only of pain (compare Job 16:9).

FROM THE VIDEO The video treads carefully: many have preached that people gnash their teeth in pain in hell. Pay attention to how Jesus carries the Old Testament context into what He says.

BACKGROUND Psalm 112:10 shows another side: 'The wicked will see it and be vexed, / He will gnash his teeth and melt away' (Psalm 112:10). Psalms 112:10

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms ◆ Factbook: Outer darkness

> *“He may take a child of the devil destined for burning and transform them into a son of the kingdom.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Wheat or weeds? Leave it to the Lord

The center of the chiasm, God's gift of time, and radical forgiveness.



MATTHEW 13:3-52

The center of the chiasm

🎯 MATTHEW 13:36-39 (LSB) CHIASM

“Then He left the crowds and went into the house. And His disciples came to Him and said, “Explain to us the parable of the tares of the field.” And He answered and said, “The one who sows the good seed is the Son of Man, and the field is the world; and as for the good seed, these are the sons of the kingdom; and the tares are the sons of the evil one; and the enemy who sowed them is the devil, and the harvest is the end of the age; and the reapers are angels.”

FROM THE VIDEO The parables of chapter 13 are arranged as a chiasm (13:3-52), and whatever sits at the center is the big idea. The video places Jesus' explanation of the tares at the center (13:36-43).

FROM THE VIDEO Of all the parables, the disciples ask about this one: 'Explain to us the parable of the tares.' The wheat are the sons of the kingdom, the tares the sons of the evil one, the enemy the devil, and the sower the Son of Man.

◆ Factbook: Chiasm ◆ Factbook: Son of Man ◆ Factbook: Satan



MATTHEW 13:29-30

God's gift of time

FROM THE VIDEO Good rabbis pointed to something nearby, so Jesus may have pointed to a real wheat field. Darnel, a common weed in Israel's wheat fields, looks so much like wheat that it is hard to tell apart, and its roots intertwine with the wheat.

FROM THE VIDEO The harvest is delayed until a time only God knows, to give people more time to repent. In that time God may choose to turn weeds into wheat: to take a child of the devil and transform them into a son of the kingdom.

BACKGROUND 'The Lord is not slow about His promise... but is patient toward you, not willing for any to perish but for all to come to repentance' (2 Peter 3:9). 2 Peter 3:9

◆ Factbook: Repentance

ACTS 9

Weeds may become wheat

🔄 ACTS 9:3-5 (LSB)

SAUL

“And as he was traveling, it happened that when he was approaching Damascus, suddenly a light from heaven flashed around him; and falling to the ground, he heard a voice saying to him, “Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting Me?” And he said, “Who are You, Lord?” And He said, “I am Jesus whom you are persecuting,”

FROM THE VIDEO Some of the same religious leaders spreading rumors about Jesus today might become His followers tomorrow. We know that was true at least of the apostle Paul.

FROM THE VIDEO The teacher shares that he was once a weed among the wheat, going to church but rejecting theology entirely, and some wrote him off; by God's grace he was transformed at thirty.

◆ Factbook: Paul

THE LESSON

Treat the lost like your own

FROM THE VIDEO The servants of Jesus must treat the lost in the world the way they treat their own, trusting that God, not man, will remove all sin and sinners on the last day.

FROM THE VIDEO The disciples cannot tell who will finally be wheat. A disciple who tries to uproot 'weeds' instead of showing mercy and forgiveness does not trust God to do justice at the harvest: that is a trust issue.

BACKGROUND Jesus had already taught: 'Love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you' (Matthew 5:44). Matthew 5:44

◆ Factbook: Forgiveness ◆ Factbook: Mercy



While his men were sleeping

Domenico Fetti, The Parable of the Weeds, c. 1622. Thyssen-Bornemisza Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"That's a trust issue, ladies and gentlemen.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 13:24-43

What the video says, then a short background note.

Jesus

VIDEO The Son of Man who sows good seed; He tells the slaves to wait for the harvest.

BACKGROUND He explains the parable privately after He 'went into the house' (13:36).

Matthew 13:36-37 ◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Son of Man ◆ Parable

The disciples

VIDEO Out of all the parables, they ask only about the tares: the center of the chiasm.

BACKGROUND Earlier they asked why He speaks in parables (13:10).

Matthew 13:10-11 ◆ Disciples

The slaves of the landowner

VIDEO Want to pull the weeds at once; the master says no.

BACKGROUND They cannot tell wheat from tares; only the reapers at the harvest will separate them.

Matthew 13:27-30

The enemy

VIDEO Secretly sows tares among the wheat: the devil.

BACKGROUND 'The enemy who sowed them is the devil' (13:39).

Matthew 13:39 ◆ Satan

John the Baptist

VIDEO Preached the axe already at the root; his picture of judgment was faster and harsher.

BACKGROUND From prison he sent to ask, 'Are You the One who is to come?' (11:3).

Matthew 3:10-12 Matthew 11:2-3 ◆ John the Baptist

Abraham and Sarah

VIDEO Prepare three seahs of fine flour for the three visitors at Mamre.

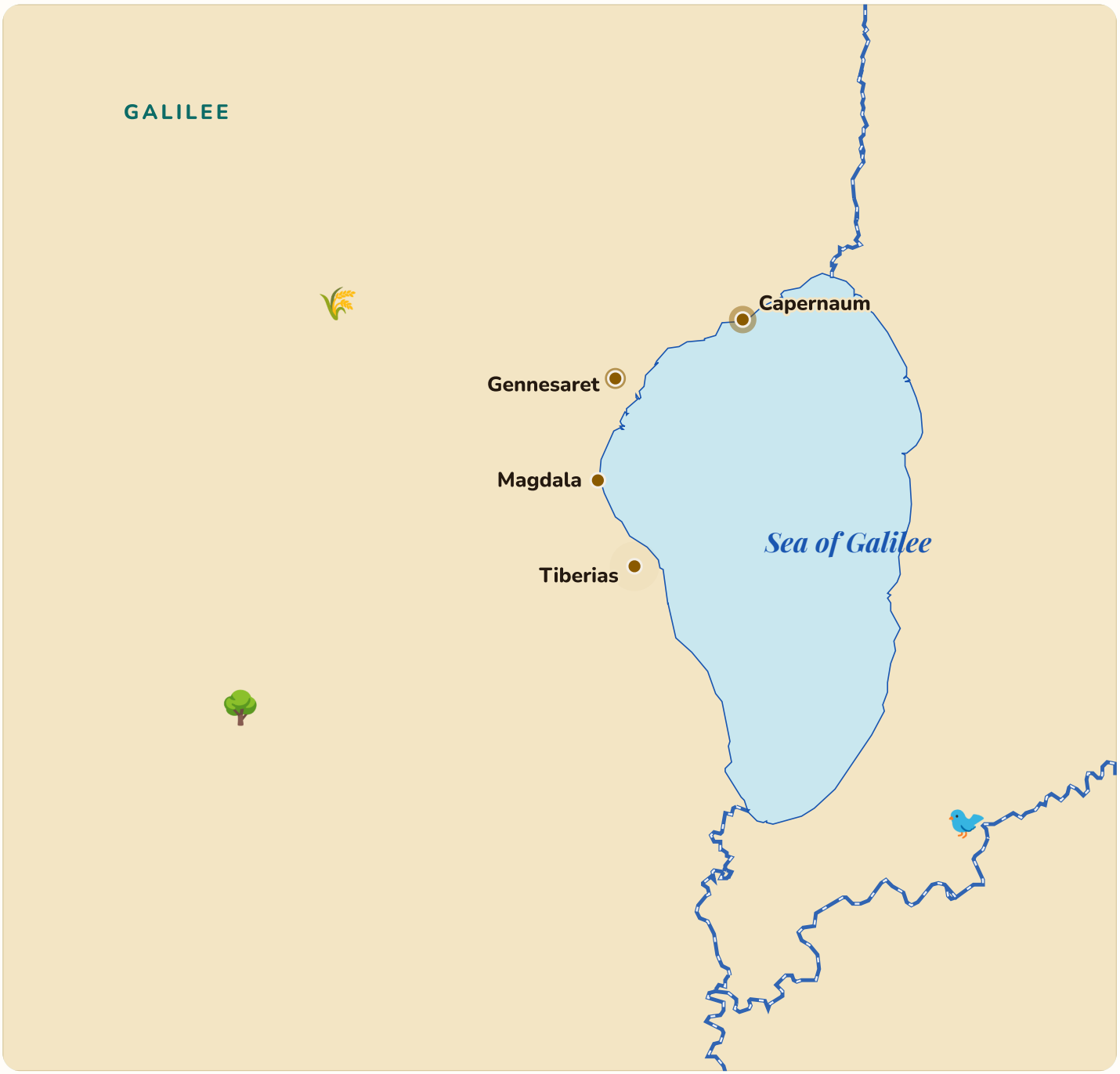
BACKGROUND Hebrews 13:2 recalls those who 'entertained angels without knowing it.'

Genesis 18:1-8 Hebrews 13:2 ◆ Abraham ◆ Sarah

07 · BACKGROUND

Fields by the lake

Gold pins are background places on the west shore of the lake.



● Named in the video ● Background

The video names no places; these pins show the farmland around the lake where Jesus taught in chapter 13. Coastline of the lake and rivers: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL); land: Natural Earth (public domain).

Capernaum BACKGROUND

'He left the crowds and went into the house' (13:36), likely in Capernaum.

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

Gennesaret BACKGROUND

The fertile plain on the west shore, full of grain fields where darnel grew among the wheat.

Magdala BACKGROUND

A fishing town on the west shore; its farmland ran up into the hills.

Tiberias BACKGROUND

Herod Antipas' new capital on the lake, built about AD 20.

◆ Factbook: Tiberias

◆ Factbook: Magdala

08

Key terms

Tares

VIDEO

Weeds sown among wheat; often identified with darnel, which looks like wheat until it heads out.

◆ Factbook: Weeds (tares, darnel)

Darnel

VIDEO

A weedy grass (Lolium temulentum) of Israel's wheat fields; the captions write 'Darnell.'

◆ Factbook: Weeds (tares, darnel)

Mustard seed

VIDEO

A proverbially tiny seed; the plant grows into a large shrub.

◆ Factbook: Mustard

Leaven

VIDEO

Old fermented dough worked into new dough so that the whole batch rises.

◆ Factbook: Leaven (yeast)

Seah

VIDEO

A dry measure, about 7 liters; three seahs (Greek sata) is a very large batch of flour. The captions write 'seyas.'

Remez

VIDEO

A hint that sends the hearer back to an Old Testament passage. The captions write 'rays' and 'rayim.'

◆ Factbook: Tanakh

Chiasm

VIDEO

A mirrored arrangement (A B C B' A') whose center carries the main idea. The captions write 'kayazm.'

◆ Factbook: Chiasm

End of the age

VIDEO

The harvest, when the Son of Man sends His angels to separate the righteous and the wicked (13:39-43).

◆ Factbook: Eschatology

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

ζιζάνιον

ἐχθρός

zizanion G2215

Tares, darnel: a weed resembling wheat. Look up: BDAG, ζιζάνιον.

Greek · Matt 13:25, 30, 38

◆ Factbook: Weeds (tares, darnel)

echthros G2190

Enemy.

Greek · Matt 13:25, 39

θερισμός

therismos G2326

Harvest.

Greek · Matt 13:30, 39

σίναπι

sinapi G4615

Mustard (the plant or its seed).

Greek · Matt 13:31

◆ Factbook: Mustard

ζύμη

zymē G2219

Leaven, yeast.

Greek · Matt 13:33

◆ Factbook: Leaven (yeast)

σάτον

saton G4568

Seah, a dry measure (Hebrew se'ah).

Greek · Matt 13:33

συντέλεια

synteleia G4930

Completion, end (of the age).

Greek · Matt 13:39

βρυγμός

brygmos G1030

Gnashing (of teeth). Look up: BDAG, βρυγμός.

Greek · Matt 13:42

סְאָה

se'ah H5429

Seah, a dry measure.

Hebrew · Gen 18:6

צִפּוֹר

tsippor H6833

Bird.

Hebrew · Ezek 17:23

חָרַק

charaq H2786

To gnash (the teeth), in hostility. Look up: BDB or HALOT, חָרַק.

Hebrew · Ps 35:16

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Darnel in the wheat

Bearded darnel grows in the same fields as wheat and looks almost identical until the ears form. Its roots tangle with the wheat's, so farmers usually waited and separated the two at harvest.

Mustard in Galilee

Black mustard grows from a tiny seed into a large annual shrub, often two or three meters tall, big enough for birds to perch in. 'Smallest of all seeds' was a proverbial way of speaking (compare 17:20).

Leaven and bread

Bread was raised with a piece of old fermented dough. Three seahs of flour, roughly 20 liters, would make bread for a large crowd, as Sarah's did for her guests.

Chiasm

Ancient writers often arranged material in mirrored patterns. Scholars outline Matthew 13 in several ways; the video's outline puts the explanation of the tares in the center.

SOURCED Early witnesses

> *or that of the very tares it is likely that many may change and become wheat. If therefore ye root them up beforehand, you injure that which is to become wheat, slaying some, in whom there is yet room for change and improvement.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 46, on 13:29. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *Yea, for His disciples were weakest of all, and least of all; but nevertheless, because of the great power that was in them, It has been unfolded in every part of the world.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 46, on 13:31-32. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *For as this converts the large quantity of meal into its own quality, even so shall you convert the whole world.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 46, on 13:33. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED Where scholars differ

Is the field the church or the world?

Jesus says 'the field is the world' (13:38). Augustine and many after him applied the parable to true and false members within the church as well; others keep it to believers and unbelievers in the world.

What does 'gnashing of teeth' mean in Matthew?

The video stresses the Old Testament sense of hostility and mockery. Others note that in Matthew it comes with 'weeping' (8:12; 13:42; 22:13; 25:30) and read it as anguish and rage at being shut out, as in Psalm 112:10.

Birds in the branches: good or bad?

The video, with many, reads the birds as the nations finding shelter (Ezekiel 17:23). A few read them as evil intruders, as in the sower (13:4, 19); most commentators prefer the first.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The video cites the gnashing verse as 'Psalm 35:15'; the words 'They gnashed at me with their teeth' are in Psalm 35:16 (the next episode gives 35:16).
- The video says the disciples 'only want to know' about the tares out of eight parables. When they ask (13:36), Jesus has told four (the sower, the tares, the mustard seed and the leaven), and He has already explained the sower; the last four come after their question.
- Psalm 37:12 and Job 16:9 do describe gnashing in hostility, but Psalm 112:10 shows the wicked gnashing in frustration, so the Old Testament use is broader than mockery alone.
- The video's outline of the chiasm, with the tares at its center, is one proposal; scholars arrange Matthew 13 in several ways.
- Craig Blomberg's words are given as the video reads them; we could not check them against his book.
- The captions write 'Solah' for the channel host's surname, 'kayazm' for chiasm, 'Blombberg' for Blomberg, 'Mray' for Mamre, 'seyas' for seahs, and 'be elible' for Beelzebul.

11 · BACKGROUND

From Mamre to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 13:24-43 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 2000 BC DEBATED
Sarah bakes from three seahs of flour
Genesis 18:6 *Remez: 13:33*

C. 1000 BC DEBATED
David: 'They gnashed at me with their teeth'
Psalms 35:16 *Remez: 13:42*

C. 588 BC DEBATED
Ezekiel's parable of the cedar sprig
Ezekiel 17:22-24 *Remez: 13:32*

C. AD 28
John: 'the axe is already laid at the root'

Matthew 3:10

C. AD 29 DEBATED

Jesus: the tares, the mustard seed and the leaven

Matthew 13:24-43 *This episode*

C. AD 34 DEBATED

Saul the persecutor meets Jesus

Acts 9:1-6

C. AD 390

Chrysostom: tares 'may change and become wheat'

Matthew 13:29

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Mark 4:30-32
Mark's mustard seed
ADDED

Luke 13:18-21
Luke's mustard seed and leaven
ADDED

Ezekiel 17:22-24
The cedar sprig
ADDED

Daniel 4:10-12
Birds in the great tree
ADDED

Genesis 18:1-8
Three seahs of flour
ADDED

Psalms 37:12-13
The wicked gnashes at the righteous
ADDED

2 Peter 3:9
Patient, not wanting any to perish
ADDED

1 Corinthians 4:5
Do not judge before the time
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ What would have surprised a first-century farmer about the master's answer in 13:29-30?

2 ☐ Why might the disciples have wanted to 'pull the weeds' when they saw the opposition to Jesus?

3 ☐ Who in your life have you quietly written off? How does this parable change how you see them?

4 ☐ How is the delay of judgment a gift? Who was given time before you, and who gave you time?

5 ☐ What do the mustard seed and the leaven teach about how God's kingdom grows?

6 ☐ Where is a 'trust issue' showing up in how you treat people who oppose you?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson for the original audience: the servants of Jesus must treat the lost in the world the way they treat their own, trusting that God, not man, will remove all sin and sinners on the last day. In the middle of all the challenges against their rabbi, Jesus teaches the disciples about God's gracious gift of time. The harvest is delayed until a moment only God knows, to give people more time to repent, and in that time God may transform weeds into wheat: instead of redeeming the world from the sinner, He can redeem the sinner from their sin through the blood of Jesus Christ. Some of the religious leaders spreading rumors might become followers tomorrow, as Paul did. So the disciples should let God do the distinguishing, trust Him patiently, and keep obeying Jesus. This means taking a gracious, merciful and radically forgiving approach to even the harshest enemies, because from the servants' perspective what appears to be weeds today may ultimately be wheat. Any disciple who tries to uproot what they believe are weeds does not trust that God will do what is right at the harvest. Does our forgiveness of sinners today reflect our trust in the Lord? Absolutely.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

this week, pray by name for one person who opposes you or your faith. Then read Acts 9:1-22 and write down what changed Saul, and what Ananias had to trust God for.

> *"The servants of Jesus must treat the lost in the world the way they treat their own.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Abraham ◆ David ◆ John the Baptist ◆ Sarah ◆ Pharisees ◆ Repentance
◆ Judgment ◆ Galilee ◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Satan ◆ Angel ◆ Capernaum ◆ Book of Psalms
◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Augustine of Hippo ◆ Chiasm ◆ Demon possession ◆ Disciples
◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Fishing ◆ Gentiles ◆ Herod Antipas ◆ Magdala ◆ Mercy ◆ Persecution
◆ Prayer ◆ Sea of Galilee ◆ Tiberias ◆ Daniel (the prophet) ◆ Forgiveness ◆ Outer darkness
◆ Paul ◆ Sinner ◆ Son of Man ◆ Tanakh ◆ Apostle ◆ Beelzebul ◆ Eschatology ◆ Messiah
◆ Parable ◆ Rabbi ◆ Saul (king of Israel) ◆ Parable of the Sower ◆ Asaph ◆ Cedar ◆ Damascus
◆ Job (man of Uz) ◆ Leaven (yeast) ◆ Mustard ◆ Weeds (tares, darnel) ◆ Wheat

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; Abraham Bloemaert, Walters Art Museum; Domenico Fetti, Thyssen-Bornemisza Museum; public domain). Map data: Natural Earth (public domain) and OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).